

The power of offloading.

What the chat logs show, and
what I changed in my own course.

EEG during essay writing

MIT Media Lab, 2025 · 54 students

Brain only strongest connectivity

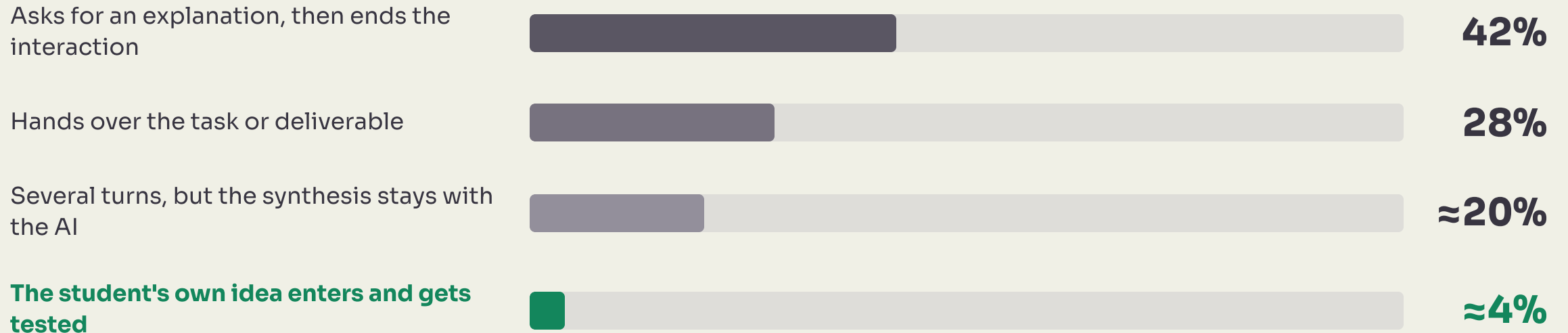
Search engine in between

LLM **weakest**

The LLM group showed weaker brain connectivity.

In search of constructive use

40,000 student messages to an AI tutor

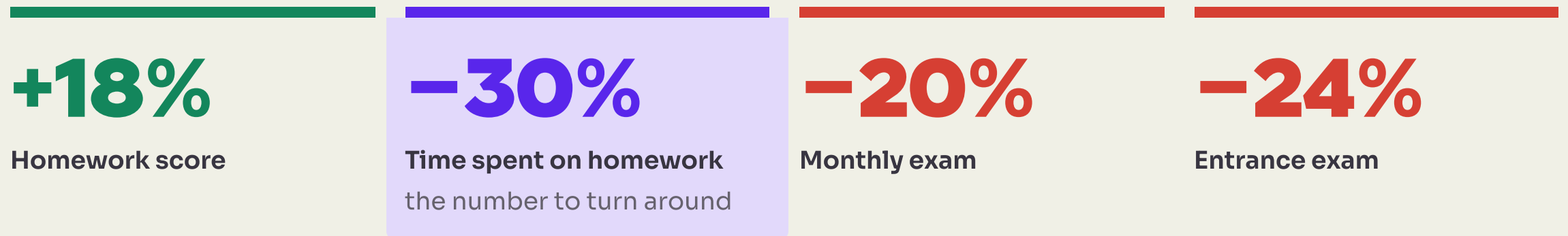


Preliminary, descriptive categorisation

Tamási, *The Power of Outsourcing*, The European Sociologist 55, 2026

Better homework, weaker exams

26,811 Chinese secondary school students, 30 months



+18%

Homework score

-30%

Time spent on homework
the number to turn around

-20%

Monthly exam

-24%

Entrance exam

Homework took less time because it could be offloaded to AI. **The exams showed it.**

Current assignments reward the result.

because that was “easy” to measure

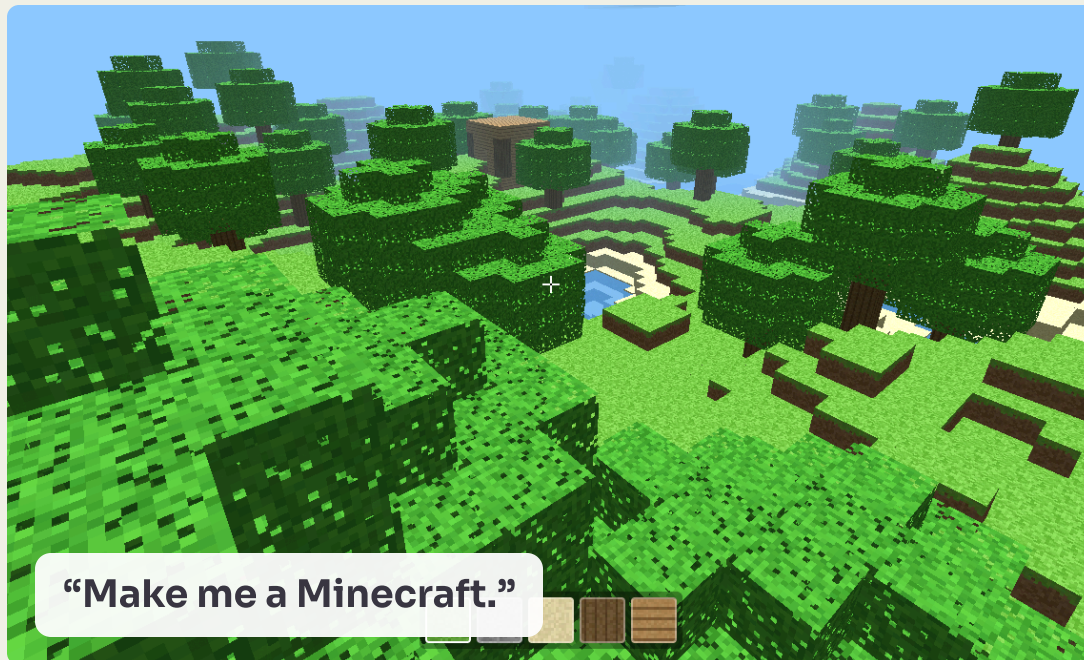
What if we rewarded the process?

Two programs, both built with AI

Vibe coding raises the floor, agentic engineering raises the ceiling.

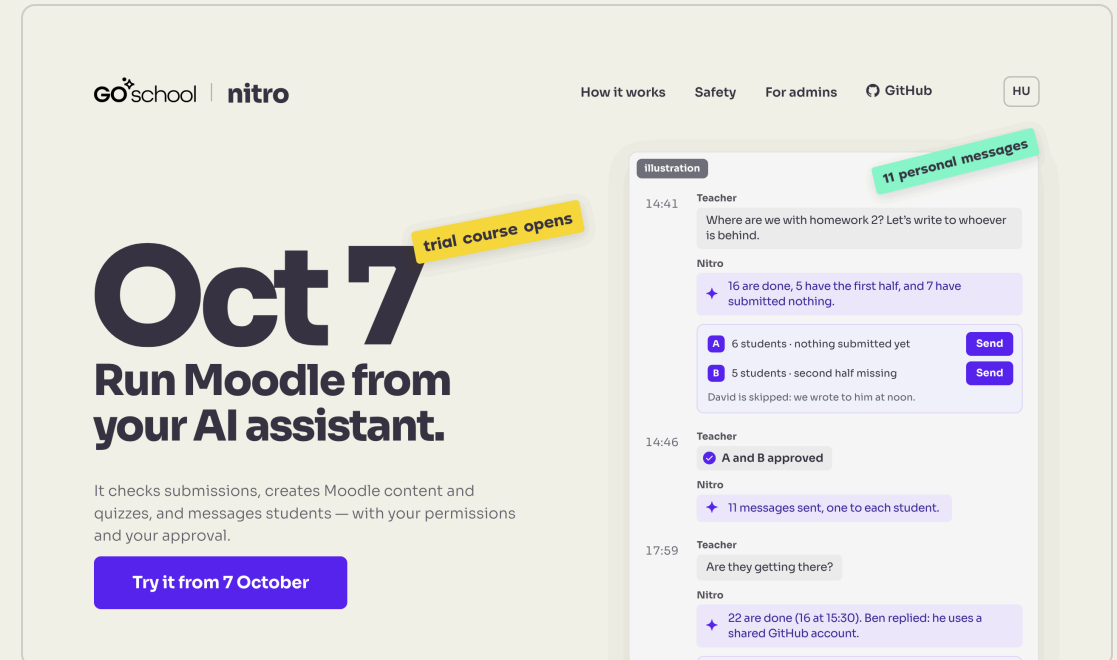
Vibe coding

a playable 3D world from one sentence



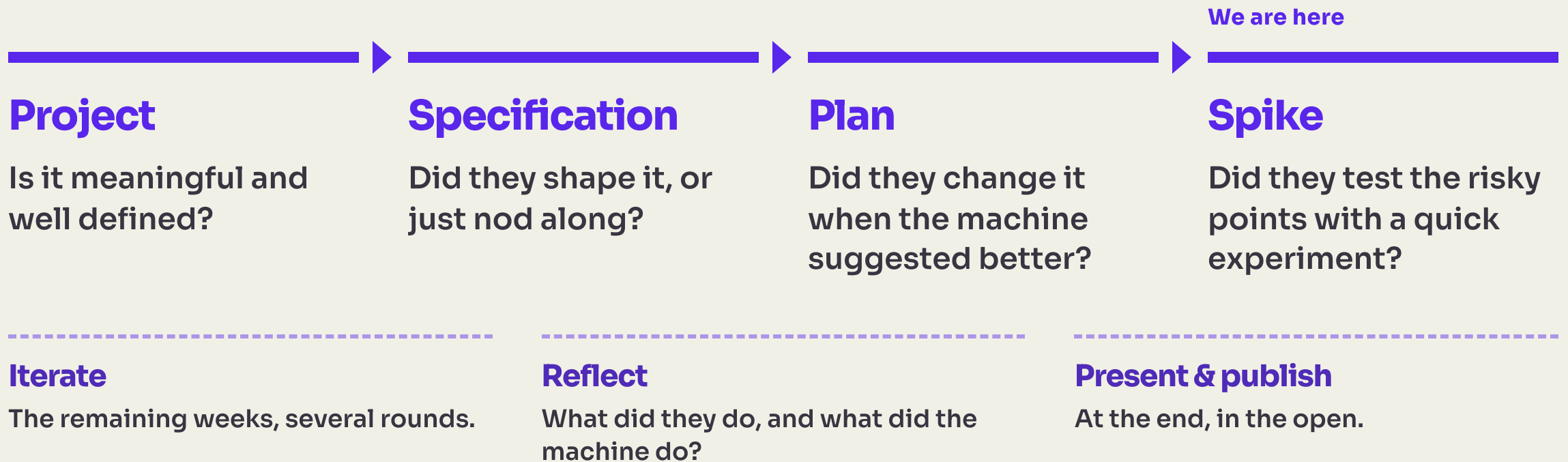
Agentic engineering

a Moodle plugin that teachers rely on



44 separate projects, worked on every week

Two courses · 28 students and 16 teachers · a course design trial

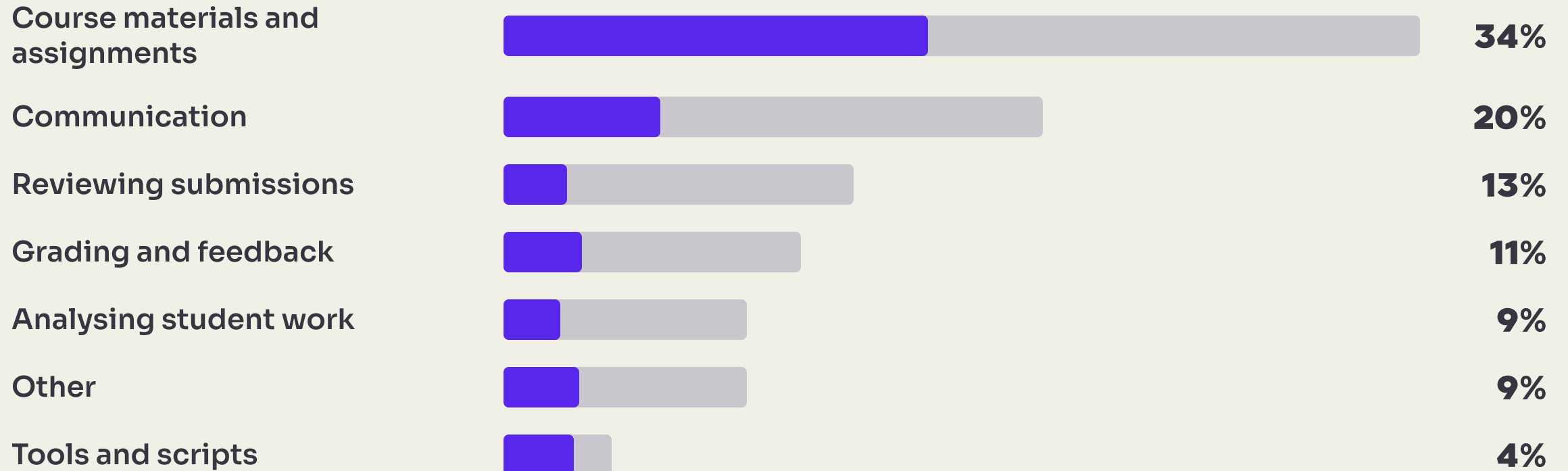


Every week, a new step on their own project. I follow it, and I support it.

Where did my time go?

Same two courses and 1,031 requests - about 115 hours, breaks excluded

■ my time ■ of this, the AI was working



For every word of mine, the AI read 44 and wrote 45

My two courses, September 2026 · 1,031 requests to the AI



15k

words I wrote

655k

words the AI read

681k

words the AI wrote

×89: every word of mine turned into 89 words of AI work.

Don't fight offloading. Use the time it frees.

Which of your tasks would make that
time worth the student's own work?



arpadtamasi.github.io/innofair-2026

discussion